

MSc Research Project/Internship/ Practicum

Results and Critical Analysis

Writing the Results Section

Announcing your findings to the world!

- In theory, this is the easiest part to write, because it is a straightforward commentary of exactly what you observed and found.
- In reality, it can be a little tricky, because it is very easy to include too much information and bury the important findings.
- **ONLY** the **most relevant results** that support your research question and objectives shall be presented
- Also, remember about report's length limitation!

Writing the Results Section

Announcing your findings to the world!

- **GOAL:** To provide a comprehensive analysis of the results and main findings of the study as well as the implications of these finding both from academic and practitioner perspective are presented



Results

Its not just about presenting results

- **Need to interpret results and describe what the results mean in detail**
 - Implications of these finding both from academic and practitioner perspective
- **How do the results relate to your research question ?**
 - Are you solving the problem
 - Are you improving the problem
- **Use visual aids such as graphs, charts, plots and so on**
- **Present an in-depth and rigorous analysis of the result**
- **It is very easy to put too much information into the results section and obscure your findings underneath reams of irrelevance.**

Too Much Information?

- If you make a table of your findings, you do not need to insert a graph highlighting the same data.
- If you have a table of results, refer to it in the text, but do not repeat the figures - duplicate information will be penalized.
- One common way of getting around this is to be less specific in the text.
 - For example, if the result in table one shows 23.9%, you could write....*Table One shows that almost a quarter of.....*

Tips for Writing a Results Section

- Perhaps the best way to use the results section is to show the most relevant information in the graphs, figures and tables.
- The text, conversely, is used to direct the reader to those, also clarifying any unclear points. The text should also act as a link to the discussion section, highlighting any correlations and findings and leaving plenty of open questions.
- Present the results and add a short discussion explaining them, before leading into the discussion proper.
- This is very common where the research paper is straightforward and provides continuity.

Tips for Writing a Results Section

- **Be sure to include negative results - writing a results section without them not only invalidate the paper, but it is extremely bad science.**
- **The negative results, and how you handle them, often gives you the makings of a great discussion section, so do not be afraid to highlight them.**

Results and Evaluation

- **You should choose criteria by which to judge your results. For example,**
 - the adequacy,
 - coverage,
 - efficiency,
 - productiveness,
 - effectiveness,
 - elegance,
 - user friendliness,
- **Then clearly, honestly and fairly adjudicate your results according to fair measures and report those results.**
- **Statistical tools should be used to critically evaluate and assess the experimental research outputs and levels of significance.**

Results and Evaluation

- **You should repeat, whenever possible, these tests against competing or previous approaches**
 - If you are clever, you will win hands down in such comparisons or such comparisons will be obviated by system differences).
- **The competing or previous approaches you compare against must have been introduced in Literature Review (in fact that may be the only reason they actively appear in Literature Review) and you should include pointers back to Literature Review.**
- **Be honest in your evaluations.**
- **If you give other approaches the benefit of the doubt every time, and develop a superior technique, your results will be all the more impressive.**